



[BIT703 Web Technologies](#) / [Contents](#) / Topic 6: Client-side web application development – CSS / Understanding CSS

CSS page layout 30m

We've looked at how the box model is used to define the layout of a web page. Now we'll briefly discuss the different layout techniques below before going into detail about the flexbox and grid box models.

Technique	Definition
Normal flow	How HTML elements are laid out and displayed by default.
Display property	This is the basis for page layout in CSS. The display property can alter the default way an element is displayed. For example, when you use a list element (), its default is to list each bullet point below each other; however, you could use the display property (display:inline) to list each point next to each other.
Flexbox	Flexbox creates layouts automatically and is very useful in modern web page designs that use columns and grids. It allows us to create a series of boxes, wrapped inside a larger box and set rules about how the boxes behave.
Grid layout	The grid property is used to define a grid layout, which consists of rows and columns, facilitating the design of web pages. Similar to flexbox, we use the display property to set up a grid.
Float	The float property changes the behaviour of an element – the element is moved to the left or right, allowing the surrounding content to float around it.
Positioning	Allows you to move an element's position. It is used to move an element from where it would have otherwise been positioned.

[Skip to main content](#)

Multi-column layout	Provides a way to distribute content into columns, similar to how content is displayed in a newspaper. The properties column-count and column-width create this page layout.
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[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

CSS

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
body {
  font-family: Arial, sans-serif;
  margin: 0;
  padding: 0;
}

/* General Container Styles */
.container {
  border: 1px solid black;
  padding: 10px;
  margin-bottom: 40px;
}

header, nav, main, aside, footer {
  margin: 5px 0;
  padding: 10px;
  border: 1px solid gray;
  background-color: #f9f9f9;
}

/* Normal Flow */
#normal-flow .container {
  /* Default styles, no specific layout applied */
}

/* Flexbox */
#flexbox {
  flexbox {
```

Normal Flow

Header

Navigation

Main Content

Sidebar

Footer

Flexbox

Header

Navigation

Main

Sidebar

Footer (Fixed Positioning)

Resources

1x 0.5x 0.25x

Rerun

Example 6.10 CSS page layouts



☒ CSS page layout

Non-Assessed

Status: Done
Skip to main content

Reset ↺

Create a webpage layout using flexbox for the main structure, apply different types of positioning to specific components, and use a multi-column layout for text content. The layout should look similar to the following example:



Screenshot © codepen.io

Step 1: HTML structure

Create a basic HTML structure with the following elements:

- A header with navigation links
- A main section containing:
 - A div for introductory text that should be displayed in multiple columns
 - A div for a featured article with an image and text
- A sidebar with a list of related articles
- A footer.

Step 2: CSS flexbox for layout

Use flexbox to create a main layout that includes the header, main, sidebar and footer.

Arrange the header and footer to be full-width, while the main content and sidebar should be side by side.

Step 3: Apply positioning

Skip to main content

Position the header to remain fixed at the top of the viewport.

Use relative positioning for the featured article in the main section to overlap an image slightly over the text.

Step 4: Multi-column layout

Apply a multi-column layout to the introductory text within the main section.

☒ I have successfully completed this task!



Were you successful? View our code below. Was yours similar?

Example 6.11 Task: CSS page layout

Previous attempts 



[Skip to main content](#)

Dig deeper

To learn more about these CSS layout techniques, read *Introduction to CSS Layout* (MDN, 2025),^{fnref:177667} which goes into detail about each layout technique with descriptions and examples.

To learn more about the different display values available in CSS, read W3Schools' *Comprehensive List of CSS Display Properties* (W3Schools, n.d.),^{fnref:8849b9} which are used to specify an element's display behaviour.



Next, let's explore flexbox in more detail.



Thoughts on this page?

